Budget and Budget Justification

Student OSPR SEED Grant, Academic Year 2026-2027

Project: Designing and Piloting a Systematic Student Managed Investment Fund: The UWA Red and White Fund

Student: Maurice D. Pugh **Faculty/Staff Mentor:** Dr. Nezha Hamoutan

A. Itemized Budget

#	Item	Unit cost	Qty	Total
1	Cloud server (virtual machine), 2 vCPU / 4 GB RAM	$24.00/month	6	$144.00
2	Automated server backups (20% of server price)	$4.80/month	6	$28.80
3	Block storage, 100 GB ($0.10/GB/month)	$10.00/month	6	$60.00
4	Full U.S. market data subscription (Alpaca Algo Trader Plus)	$99.00/month	2	$198.00
5	Large-format research poster, printing and mounting (estimate)	$65.00/poster	1	$65.00
	TOTAL REQUESTED			**$495.80**

The total of $495.80 is within the $500 maximum. The remaining $4.20 is held unallocated to absorb minor price differences at the time of purchase. Costs are based on vendor list prices retrieved October 9, 2026 and assume a six-month active period beginning at the official award date; hosting quantities will be adjusted to the actual award date with OSPR approval.

B. Budget Justification

1. Cloud server, $144.00 (6 months at $24). The project's simulated trading platform will run on a single virtual server hosting the trade ledger database, the order-fill engine, the strategy-execution and backtesting jobs, and the dashboard that student investors use. A 2 vCPU / 4 GB server is the smallest size that can run the database and backtests at the same time as the dashboard for a team of students. This is a software and infrastructure cost required for the approved project period.

2. Server backups, $28.80 (6 months at $4.80). The ledger is the official record of every simulated trade and the basis for the final compliance and performance report. Automated backups, priced by the vendor at 20% of the server price, protect that record against data loss.

3. Block storage, $60.00 (100 GB for 6 months at $0.10 per GB). Backtesting multiple years of price history for the fund's eligible U.S.-listed securities requires more space than the server includes. The estimated 100 GB holds historical price data and trade logs. Storage can be reduced if less is needed.

4. Market data subscription, $198.00 (2 months at $99). The vendor's free plan provides only single-exchange (IEX) real-time data and limits recent historical data to more than 15

minutes old. The paid plan provides full U.S. exchange coverage without that limit. The subscription will be used for two months only: one month to validate backtested strategies against complete-market prices, and one month during the evaluation period so simulated fills and benchmark comparisons use complete-market data. All other development and student training will use the free plan. Vendor terms for academic team use will be confirmed before purchase.

5. Research poster, $65.00 (estimate). The program requires awardees to present a poster at the Academic Research Conference on March 3-4, 2027. This covers printing and mounting one large-format poster. A written quote from a print provider will be obtained before purchase and the amount adjusted to the actual quote.

C. Costs Not Requested

No funds are requested for investment capital, salaries, stipends, or other compensation for the student, mentor, or student team; tuition, textbooks, or course materials; personal equipment; or travel. The simulated fund involves no real capital.

D. Purchasing and Compliance

No purchase or financial commitment will be made before the official award notice and OSPR authorization. All purchases will be coordinated in advance with my faculty mentor and OSPR and will follow UWA purchasing and procurement procedures. I will not use personal funds without prior written OSPR authorization. Any change to the budget will be requested from OSPR in writing before it is made.

E. Cost Documentation (vendor list prices, retrieved October 9, 2026)

- DigitalOcean Droplet pricing, Basic 2 vCPU / 4 GB: $24/month; backups at 20% of Droplet price; block storage $0.10/GB/month. digitalocean.com/pricing
- Alpaca Market Data API, subscription plans: Basic (free, IEX only) and Algo Trader Plus ($99/month, all U.S. exchanges). docs.alpaca.markets
- Poster printing: estimate; written quote to be attached when obtained.